

AI READINESS WORKBOOK

Risks, Opportunities and Next Steps for Cultural and Creative Organisations

This workbook gives cultural and creative organisations a practical framework for understanding current exposure to AI, identifying opportunities, and deciding what controls and next steps are needed. It is designed for executive leadership, senior management teams, and boards to read and work through together.

Why AI Readiness Matters Now

AI is already entering cultural and creative organisations through everyday tools, staff experimentation, suppliers, partners, audiences and creative workflows.

Advances in AI are increasing risks around cybersecurity, IP rights, personal data and confidential information. At the same time, AI can support more efficient ways of operating, managing and communicating within cultural institutions.

AI readiness means knowing:

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|----|--|----|---|
| 01 | Where AI is already being used across the organisation. | 04 | Which tools are approved for staff use. |
| 02 | Which activities create data, IP, copyright, confidentiality or reputational risk. | 05 | What data and information should never be entered into public AI tools. |
| 03 | Which workflows could benefit from safe AI support. | 06 | Who remains accountable for AI-assisted outputs. |
| | | 07 | How benefits and risks will be measured. |

Current Exposure and Risk Areas

Most cultural and creative organisations are already exposed to AI-related risk before they have formally adopted an AI strategy or issued organisation-wide guidance. A priority is to understand where AI may already be in use, where that use creates exposure, and what controls are needed.

Your organisation should know whether staff, suppliers or partners are using AI in the following areas, because these uses may involve personal data, confidential information, copyrighted material, public-facing content or operational decisions.

Potential exposure points for immediate review

These examples do not imply confirmed non-compliance. They identify where AI use could create GDPR, IP, confidentiality, cybersecurity, fraud or reputational exposure if unmanaged.

01 Staff using public AI tools with internal material Board papers, HR documents, contracts, financial information, strategy notes or internal reports may be copied into public AI tools for drafting, summarising or rewriting. MAIN RISKS Confidential information exposure; personal data processing without safeguards; loss of control over sensitive organisational material.	02 Audience, donor or CRM data being analysed with AI Staff may use AI to analyse survey responses, audience feedback, donor notes, booking patterns or stakeholder information. MAIN RISKS GDPR exposure; donor/audience trust risk; inaccurate or biased analysis.
03 Creative and production materials being entered into AI tools Scripts, exhibition content, production photography, archive material, design references, rehearsal or workshop notes, performer and artist images, or artist-created assets may be used in AI tools. MAIN RISKS Copyright or licence breach; unclear ownership of AI-assisted outputs; lack of artist or performer consent; attribution issues; reputational risk with artists, writers and rights holders.	04 AI transcription, marketing or supplier tools operating without review AI meeting summaries, marketing generators, translation tools, ticketing platforms, CRM systems or email tools may already be processing organisational data through embedded AI features. MAIN RISKS Unknown data processing, retention or reuse; supplier terms may not meet your organisation's requirements; confidential meetings may be recorded or summarised without proper notice.
05 AI-enabled cybersecurity and fraud exposure AI may be used to create convincing phishing emails, fake invoices, malicious links, synthetic voice messages, impersonation of senior staff or suppliers, or attacks on email accounts, the website or key IT systems. MAIN RISKS Financial loss; payment fraud; system compromise; data breach; operational disruption; reputational damage; loss of trust with suppliers, donors, audiences or artists.	

AI Readiness Diagnostic

Use this diagnostic to assess your organisation’s current AI maturity. Score each area honestly — the value of the workbook lies in the conversation the scores prompt.

MATURITY SCALE

1	2	3	4	5			
No clear position; use is unknown or unmanaged	Informal experimentation; inconsistent controls	Basic guidance exists; useful use cases identified	Managed adoption; clear ownership, tools, training and controls	Integrated practice; benefits and risks are actively measured			
AREA		KEY QUESTION	1	2	3	4	5
01	Leadership & governance	Does your organisation have clear executive and board ownership of AI risk and opportunity?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
02	GDPR, data protection & confidentiality	Do staff know what information can and cannot be used in AI tools?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
03	Cybersecurity, fraud & supplier risk	Has your organisation assessed AI-enabled fraud, phishing and supplier platform risks?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
04	Approved tools & access	Has your organisation identified which AI tools are approved, for which purposes, and under what conditions?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
05	Staff use, skills & confidence	Do staff know how to use AI safely, critically and productively in line with organisational policies?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
06	Workflow & productivity opportunities	Has your organisation mapped where AI could support recurring work across creative production, operations, fundraising, marketing and governance — and how benefits will be measured?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
07	Knowledge, archive & reusable assets	Can your organisation safely use its existing policies, reports, templates, board papers, production records and archive material as organisational knowledge?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
08	Creative rights, IP & accountability	Does your organisation have clear principles for AI use involving scripts, images, recordings, designs, artists' materials, archive material and public-facing content?	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

HOW TO INTERPRET THE SCORES

MOSTLY 1S AND 2S

Your organisation has unmanaged exposure.

The priority is control:

- map current use
- issue interim guidance
- identify approved tools
- review data and confidentiality risks
- add AI to the risk register

MOSTLY 3S

Your organisation has started to respond.

The priority is structure:

- map workflows
- train staff
- select pilot use cases
- define review and approval processes
- report progress to leadership and the board

MOSTLY 4S AND 5S

Your organisation is ready to scale adoption.

The priority is improvement:

- measure benefits
- refine governance
- expand safe use cases
- improve knowledge management
- embed AI into priority workflows

What Success Looks Like

An AI-ready cultural organisation does not replace people with technology. It uses AI to reduce friction, improve coordination, strengthen governance and give staff more time for judgment, relationships and delivery.

Administration

The organisation uses AI to reduce repetitive drafting, formatting, summarising and coordination work.

First drafts of reports, briefings, policies and funding materials are produced faster, drawing more effectively on existing knowledge and data. Meeting notes, actions and summaries become easier to produce and share. Teams reduce duplication across departments.

Risk and governance

The organisation knows where AI is being used and applies proportionate controls.

AI appears on the organisational risk register. Staff understand what data must not be entered into AI tools. Approved tools and prohibited uses are clearly defined. Supplier AI features are reviewed. Public-facing AI-assisted content is checked before release.

Production and operations

AI supports planning, documentation, handovers and reporting.

Production teams spend less time creating and reworking routine documentation. Risk assessments, access notes and technical checklists become more consistent. Show reports and post-production learning are easier to capture and share.

Fundraising and development

AI supports research, drafting, stakeholder mapping and impact reporting.

Donor, trust and stakeholder research becomes faster. Funding applications and impact reports move from blank page to review draft more quickly. Funder-facing claims remain accurate, evidenced and human-reviewed.

Marketing and audience development

AI supports campaign development, audience insight, accessibility and communication.

Marketing teams create more campaign variants without losing the organisation's voice. Audience feedback and survey data are analysed more consistently. Accessibility, plain-English and multilingual materials become easier to produce.

People and creative judgment

AI supports staff, artists and leadership without replacing judgment.

Staff understand when to use AI and when not to. Final decisions remain with accountable people. Artistic, contractual, safeguarding and reputational decisions stay human-led. Artists and creative teams understand how AI may or may not be used.

Knowledge and archive

The organisation makes better use of its existing knowledge, archive and institutional memory.

Teams can draw on previous reports, templates, policies and production records more easily. New staff and partners can access clearer onboarding and background material. Past productions, audience insights and funding materials inform future work.

What To Do Next

Cultural and creative organisations should take a staged approach over the first 90 days:

1 *Establish control.*

FIRST 30 DAYS

Establish control

ACTIONS

- Map current AI use across staff and partners.
- Identify high-risk information, including audience, donor, HR, artist, contract, board and financial data.
- Identify any immediate GDPR, confidentiality or cyber concerns.
- Add AI to the organisational risk register.
- Define approved and non-approved tools.
- Issue interim AI usage guidance.

OUTPUT

Current exposure map and interim AI guidance.

2 *Identify value.*

DAYS 30–60

Identify value

ACTIONS

- Map recurring workflows across production, operations, fundraising, marketing and governance.
- Identify 3–5 low-risk, high-utility pilot use cases.
- Agree approval rules for public-facing AI-assisted material.
- Identify training needs for staff and managers.

OUTPUT

Prioritised AI opportunity map and pilot plan.

3 *Pilot and measure.*

DAYS 60–90

Pilot and measure

ACTIONS

- Train pilot users and agree use-case owners.
- Test AI in selected workflows.
- Track time saved, quality improved and risks identified.
- Review staff confidence and adoption.
- Capture lessons and refine guidance.
- Report findings to the executive team and board.
- Decide whether to scale, pause or redesign each pilot.

OUTPUT

AI readiness update report and next-stage adoption plan.